

Sunday, 30 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Showers 22° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Showers 21° 15°	MANCHESTER Showers 20° 15°	GLASGOW Heavy rain 18° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Sarah Ferguson, the former Duchess of York, is reportedly returning to the UK 'shortly', with sources suggesting she's rented a home in the Home Counties.

This move comes after a period of time spent abroad, and her return is expected to draw significant public interest. Details about her long-term plans remain private, but her presence back in the UK will be closely watched.

ROYALS · UK
- 2

Heartfelt tributes are being paid by football fans to two police officers who tragically died in a head-on collision near Middlesbrough.

PC Matthew Blades and PC Tom Clough lost their lives on the A66, prompting an outpouring of grief and respect from the community. The incident has cast a sombre mood over the region.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 3

Organisers of a Christian festival have expressed their devastation after a man died when a sign fell at the event.

The incident at the Big Church Festival also left at least six other people injured. Police have begun an investigation into what happened at the popular gathering.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 4

At least 37 people have died and hundreds evacuated after a strike on a Kyiv weapons depot, raising serious questions about military storage.

The incident, near a residential area, has prompted an investigation into the safety protocols for storing weapons for Ukraine's military. It highlights the ongoing risks faced by civilians in the conflict zone.

INTERNATIONAL · UKRAINE
- 5

After a summer tour, Prime Minister Burnham now faces his first real parliamentary test as MPs return to Westminster.

The imminent return of Parliament means the new prime minister will be under intense scrutiny, with MPs eager to grill him on his policies and performance. It marks a significant moment for his administration.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Charli XCX absolutely electrified Reading Festival with a set spanning her entire career, delighting thousands of fans.**

The British singer was one of the headliners on the first night of Reading 2026, delivering a high-energy performance. Her show proved why she's one of the UK's most exciting pop artists.

ON AIR – What's the best festival set you've ever seen? Was it Charli XCX at Reading?

MUSIC · TODAY

2 **Paul Heaton has scored his first number one album, while Dolly Parton's classic '9 to 5' finally makes it into the UK top 40.**

Heaton's solo effort has topped the charts, a fantastic achievement for the veteran musician. Meanwhile, the iconic Dolly Parton track from 1980 has, at long last, reached the UK's top 40.

ON AIR – It's taken '9 to 5' 46 years to reach the UK top 40! What other classic songs do you think deserve a chart resurgence?

MUSIC · TODAY

3 **The official preview of the highly anticipated Grand Theft Auto 6 has left fans and critics thoroughly impressed.**

The blockbuster video game is set to be one of the biggest releases in years, and this first look suggests it will live up to expectations. Gamers everywhere are buzzing with excitement.

ON AIR – Are you a Grand Theft Auto fan? What are you hoping for from the new game?

GAMING · COMING UP

4 **Matt Lucas and Hugh Bonneville are among actors calling for a new law to protect voices from AI cloning.**

Performers are urging the government to give everyone in the UK a legal right to own their voice. This comes as AI technology makes it increasingly easy to replicate voices without consent.

ON AIR – Do you think people should legally own their voice? Could AI voice cloning be a real problem?

TECHNOLOGY · FUTURE

5 **Actor Jacob Elordi has revealed that working on Sir Ridley Scott's new post-apocalyptic epic, 'The Dog Stars', made him question his own life.**

The film explores themes of hope in a pandemic-riddled world, prompting Elordi to ask himself 'What am I missing?' in life. It sounds like a powerful and thought-provoking movie.

ON AIR – Have you ever seen a film that made you totally re-evaluate your own life?

FILM · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 Dan Lawrence has impressed in challenging conditions, pushing England towards a series win over Pakistan in the second Test.**

Despite weather delays on day three, Lawrence showed resilience at the crease, helping England build a strong lead. His performance has been crucial in a difficult batting environment.

ON AIR – Test cricket in August – is it the best way to spend a bank holiday weekend, or would you rather be doing something else?

CRICKET · UK
- 2 Liverpool are reportedly closing in on a massive £123 million deal to sign PSG forward Bradley Barcola.**

This potential signing could cast doubt over the future of Cody Gakpo at Anfield, as the Reds look to bolster their attacking options. It's a huge transfer story brewing.

ON AIR – £123 million for a player – is that the new normal in football, or is it just excessive?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 Hull City striker Oli McBurnie has playfully hit back at critics after his team's perfect start to the Premier League season.**

Hull beat Coventry to win their opening two games, prompting McBurnie to quip 'Not bad for the worst team in Premier League history'. It's a confident start for the Tigers!

ON AIR – Which Premier League team has surprised you the most with their start to the season?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Britain's Charlotte Henshaw has won her 12th Para-canoe World Championship title, just 11 days after being in hospital.**

Henshaw's incredible achievement comes less than two weeks after she was admitted with cellulitis. It's an inspiring display of strength and determination.

ON AIR – What an incredible comeback! Have you ever achieved something amazing shortly after overcoming a challenge?

PARA-SPORT · UK
- 5 Race leader Tadej Pogacar has been forced to abandon the Vuelta a España after a dramatic crash during stage eight.**

The Slovenian cyclist was a favourite for the title, making his withdrawal a significant blow to the race. It's a reminder of the dangers of professional cycling.

ON AIR – How much does it change a major cycling race when the favourite has to pull out due to injury?

CYCLING · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1** **Gardeners across the UK are discovering the calming effects of 'moon gardens', designed to be enjoyed after dusk.**
These special spaces feature plants with pale or silvery foliage and white flowers that glow in the moonlight, often chosen for their evening fragrance, too. It's a lovely way to unwind after a busy day.
- 2** **A new trend sees people creating 'miniature libraries' inside disused telephone boxes, offering a charming local book exchange.**
These tiny, community-run spaces are popping up in villages and towns, providing a free and accessible way for neighbours to share books and foster a sense of local connection.
- 3** **Researchers suggest that regularly 'doodling during meetings' can actually boost memory and concentration, rather than hinder it.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, scientists say that light doodling helps keep the mind engaged and prevents it from wandering completely, aiding information retention. So, get those pens out!
- 4** **The simple pleasure of 'baking bread from scratch' is experiencing a surge in popularity as a mindful and rewarding hobby.**
Beyond the delicious aroma and taste, many are finding the process of kneading dough and watching it rise to be a surprisingly therapeutic and satisfying activity, connecting them to traditional skills.
- 5** **Scientists have found that 'listening to the sound of rainfall' can significantly reduce stress and improve sleep quality.**
The consistent, non-threatening ambient noise of rain acts as a natural white noise, masking other sounds and promoting a sense of calm, making it a popular choice for relaxation. No wonder we Brits love a good downpour!
- 6** **There's a delightful movement to 'rekindle the art of writing postcards' when on holiday, rather than just snapping photos.**
People are rediscovering the joy of sending a personalised message and a physical memento from their travels, bringing a smile to the faces of friends and family back home. Much more charming than an email!
- 7** **More people are embracing 'upcycling old furniture' to give it a new lease of life, rather than buying new.**
This creative trend not only helps the environment by reducing waste but also allows individuals to create unique, bespoke pieces that reflect their personal style and add character to their homes.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of tea will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: ...GIVING THE BOX A GOOD SHAKE TO SEE IF THE TEABAGS RATTLE 'JUST RIGHT'!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, fresh slice of toast, especially if it's a new loaf. What is it?

ANSWER: ...PRESSING DOWN ON THE TOP OF THE LOAF TO CHECK FOR THE PERFECT SPRINGINESS!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' can be surprisingly comforting or even nostalgic, even if it's not music?

Maybe it's the distant rumble of a train, the gentle hum of the fridge, or the distinct clink of certain cutlery. What ordinary sound instantly makes you feel cosy or takes you back in time, and why?

- We all have those 'little everyday inventions' that we think are absolutely genius, even if they're just things we've cobbled together at home, don't we?

Perhaps it's a clever way to keep cables tidy, a brilliant use for an old container, or a unique method for peeling vegetables. What's your most ingenious 'home-grown' solution to an everyday problem?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies can only see in black and white, which is why they are attracted to colourful flowers.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£67 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£67 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first postage stamp, the Penny Black, was issued in the United Kingdom in 1840.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- The longest place name in the UK is 'Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogogoch' in Wales.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'Go!'

On this day

Day 242 of the year, 123 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Constantinople (Eastern Orthodoxy); Christian feast day: Blessed Alfredo Ildefonso Schuster; Christian feast day: Blessed Eustáquio van Lieshout; Christian feast day: Blessed Stephen Nehmé (Maronite Church / Catholic Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — David Paymer, American actor and director
- 1968 — Diran Adebayo, English author and critic
- 1966 — Michael Michele, American actress
- 1950 — Dana Rosemary Scallon, Irish singer and activist
- 1971 — Lars Frederiksen, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1966 — Peter Cunnah, Northern Irish singer-songwriter and producer
- 1951 — Timothy Bottoms, American actor
- 1985 — Richard Duffy, Welsh footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1967 — Thurgood Marshall is confirmed as the first African American Justice of the Supreme Court of the United States.
- 1963 — The Moscow–Washington hotline between the leaders of the U.S. and the Soviet Union goes into operation.
- 2021 — The last remaining American troops leave Afghanistan, ending U.S. involvement in the war.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1936 — The RMS Queen Mary wins the Blue Riband by setting the fastest transatlantic crossing.
- 2021 — The last remaining American troops leave Afghanistan, ending U.S. involvement in the war.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2008 — A Conviasa Boeing 737 crashes into Illiniza Volcano in Ecuador, killing all three people on board.
- 1945 — The Japanese occupation of Hong Kong comes to an end.
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1974 — The Third World Population Conference ends in Bucharest, Romania. At the end of the ceremony, the UN-Romanian Demographic Centre is inaugurated.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 243 of the year, 122 days left in 2026. Today Baloch-Pakhtun Unity Day (Balochs and Pashtuns, International observance); Christian feast day: Aidan of Lindisfarne; Christian feast day: Aristides of Athens; Christian feast day: Cuthburh. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1979 — Simon Neil, Scottish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1967 — Gene Hoglan, American drummer
- 1960 — Chris Whitley, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2005)
- 1992 — Holly Earl, British actress
- 1940 — Larry Hankin, American actor, director, and producer
- 1971 — Kirstie Allsopp, British TV presenter
- 1980 — Joe Budden, American broadcaster and former rapper
- 1986 — Ryan Kelley, American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1959 — A parcel bomb sent by Ngô Đình Nhu, younger brother and chief adviser of South Vietnamese President Ngô Đình Diệm, fails to kill King Norodom Sihanouk of Cambodia.
- 2016 — Brazil's President Dilma Rousseff is impeached and removed from office.
- 1986 — The Soviet passenger liner Admiral Nakhimov sinks in the Black Sea after colliding with the bulk carrier Pyotr Vasev, killing 423.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1988 — Delta Air Lines Flight 1141 crashes during takeoff from Dallas/Fort Worth International Airport, killing 14.
- 2005 — The 2005 Al-Aimmah bridge stampede in Baghdad kills 953 people.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar